

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2018

Solution and marking.

Scoring (max 25)

- A. 1 point for each correct cell. (max 12)
- B. 2 points for each correct answer. (max 4)
 - 1 point with one wrong word.
- C. 2 points for each correct escutcheon. (max 4)
 - 1 point with one error.
- D. 5 points for a perfect answer.
 - 1 point for general clarity.
 - 1 point for syntax.
 - 1 point for shapes.
 - 1 point for colours.
 - 1 point for relationships.
 - Don't expect the technical terms used in the explanation below.

a.	description	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
	blazon	F	D	K	I	L	J	A	G	B	E	H	C	
b.	M	Argent two chevrons sable between three roses gules												
	N	Gules a chevron sable between two annulets azure impaling azure three crosses crosslet argent one one one												
c.	1.							2.						

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Commentary

(Note that much of this is not required to solve the problem - however, for the sake of completeness I will try to explain everything)

The syntax of a blazon description

Field partition	Field colour(s) (<i>tincture</i>)	Ordinary charges (bands)	Mobile charges (symbols)
0 (nothing) <i>Per pale</i> <i>Per fess</i> <i>Per chevron</i> <i>Per bend</i> <i>Quarterly</i>	<i>Argent</i> <i>Or</i> <i>Azure</i> <i>Gules</i> <i>Vert</i> <i>Sable</i>	<i>Fess</i> <i>Chevron</i> <i>Bend</i> <i>Bend sinister</i> <i>Cross</i> <i>Chief</i>	<i>Rose</i> <i>Annulet</i> <i>Roundel</i> <i>Cross crosslet</i> <i>Lozenge</i> <i>Gouttes</i>

- If the field is partitioned, the tinctures are described left-to-right and top-to-bottom.
- The field can also be checky, in which case the colours involved are placed straight afterwards.

Variation of ordinaries

- Ordinaries can be embattled or indented to vary their shape.

Tincture of charges

- The tincture of charges is placed after the charge (i.e. a rose sable is a black rose).
- If a charge is counterchanged, it swaps the colours of the field behind it (e.g. if the field was partitioned into azure and vert, the part of the charge in the vert section would be azure and the part in the azure section would be vert).

Location of mobile charges

- When a mobile charge is on an ordinary, the ordinary is preceded by *on* (e.g. on a bend sable two lozenges vert)
- Otherwise, the ordinary can be between the mobile charges or the exact location can be specified (in dexter chief a roundel sable = a black roundel in the top-left). Note that dexter refers to the left of the escutcheon and sinister to the right.
- If there are multiple mobile charges and their orientation relative to each other needs to be described, the tincture is followed by the number of charges in each row (so 5 gold rings could be arranged in a row of 2 and a row of 3, in which case it would be five annulets or two three, or a row of 2, then 1, then 2, in which case it would be five annulets or two one two).

Quarterly

- The 4 quarters are numbered 1-4, with 1 and 3 being identical and 2 and 4 being identical also. The first tincture is for 1&4, the second for 2&3.
- If more needs to be described, the syntax is Quarterly 1 & 4 _____, 2 & 3 _____

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Impaling

- Two sets of arms can be combined into one by impaling them together. This takes blazon description A and description B and puts them together as such: A impaling B

Bordure

- A border can be placed around an escutcheon and it is described like an ordinary but is described last in the blazon system.

2.1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
	G	Q	T	K	B	M	P	A	R	N	I	W
	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	
	D	F	V	S	E	U	H	O	L	C	J	
2.2	a. I need your big boat						b. I need that bear					
	c. I need this big ash						d. I need my own meat					
	e. I need that cap over there											
2.3	a. ñi ʈpilaʈɪfɪk'ekiɖ / xekiɖ						b. ñi ñzaqoxekiɖ					
	c. ñi ahaqxekiɖ						d. ñi ʈəjɪkxekiɖ					
	e. ñi ñzrovsk'ekiɖ / xekiɖ											

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Commentary

(From NACLO solution – presumably written by the author.)

How to solve:

Easy step 1

- See that ñi = I
- See that xekiɖ = need (x ɛk' aft er f and s)
- alternate analysis zyæfk' and liysk' end in k' (xɛɛ/aft er k')
- These analyses might not pop out at fi rst, but they are seeable.

Easy step 2

- Count the nouns in the English translations.
- See that fi sh shows up 3 times.
- See that cap shows up 5 times.
- See that hut shows up 1 time.
- See that all other nouns show up twice.

Step 3a

- Look for correspondences in the Nivkh data (looking for fish, cap, and hut)

Step 3b

- Notice 'pila' (could initially mean 'big' or 'over there' by factoring out all of the nouns – cap is tricky, but the others are easy)
- Noti ce ɬo 3 ti mes (after segmentati on of pila), ɬo = fish
- Noti ce ñivra = my hut, so ivra = hut, ñ means my, which is nice because it goes with ñi=I
- Noti ce (h)aq = hut (5 ti mes) – the h will be tricky

Step 4

- figure out if pila is 'big' or 'over there'
- compare ɬpilazyæfk' and tɛpilaɬo = ??(that or this)- pila –fi sh
- Notice that the two words containing pila have diff erent prefixes (t vs. ɬ)
- Look at the other sentences that contain 'big' or 'over there' in their translations.
- zyæfk' = either boat or bear
- Compare I need that boat over there vs I need that fish over there
- Notice that the prefixes don't match
- Compare I need this big fish with I need your big bear
- Notice they have different prefixes, so tɛ = this, ɬ=your
- Now you can match up 13 with D, 19 with H, 7 with P and 8 with A, ...

Step 5

- You still have ɬo and a -ɬo – one means a fish and the other means that fish over there
- Notice a -mu and ñ-mu. ñmu is my _____. Of the nouns that appear twice, boat, branch, and picture have 'my' in their translation.

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- Only 'boat' also goes with 'that over there', none have 'a' translations. So mu = boat, ñ = my, and a = 'that over there'.
- So 1=G, 16=S, 14=F and 20=O

Step 6 : Cap

- aq shows up 5 times (it is haq, and x 22/after a prefix) :
 - 2: ñi hæ-haq-xekið
 - 5: ñi ñ-aq-xekið
 - 12: ñi ʈ-aq-xekið
 - 17: ñi ñ-it'ulv-haq-xekið
 - 21: ñi haq-xekið
- Meanings :
 - B : 'I need my cap'
 - E: 'I need my winter cap'
 - L; 'I need a cap'
 - Q: 'I need that cap'
 - W: 'I need your cap'
- evident that 12=W, 5=B, 17=E (so it'ulv(h) = winter, but the 'h' shows up in 21 too, so it'ulv)
- a cap vs that cap, we know 'a' = no prefix on fi sh, and haqxekið is obviously less prefixed than hæhaqxekið, so haq = cap (h deletes)
- after a C, or after 'my' and 'your') hæ = that
- 21=L, 2=Q

Step 7

- hæ-zaqo and ʈ-zaqo = that X and your X, so zaqo = knife and 9=R and 18=U
- liysk' and ʈ-liysk' = a X and your X, so liysk' = wolf and 10=N and 23=J
- ʈ-efl ank and ñ-efl ank = your X and my X, so 22=C and 4=K
- p'-eznai and ʈ-eznai = my own X (we haven't seen p' before, but we know ʈ is 'your') and your X, so 6=M and 15=V
- i-təfk' and təfk' = his/her X (by elimination) and a X, so 3=T and 11=I

The only thing left was the vowels of the prefixes of a few forms. I took the offenders out. I modified the answers so that there are 2 right answers for 2 of the Eng to Nivkh translations.

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Problem 2.3 Menya

3.1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17
3.2	a.								b.								
	c.								d.								
3.3	e.								f.								
	g.																
3.4																	

Solution and marking.

Scoring (max 32)

- 3.1. 1 point for each correct cell. (max 17)
- 3.2. 2 points for each correct Menya answer. (max 8)
 - 1 point with one error
- 3.3. 2 points for each correct answer. (max 6)
 - 1 point for one error
- 3.4. 1 point for the correct word. (max 1)

3.1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17
	p	k	a	l	o	b	d	n	c	e	m	i	g	q	h	f	j
3.2	a. naqä								b. yä wäñqä (tree/wood small)								
	c. botqi (botqä+i)								d. yññä wäñqänäñä								
3.3	e. a very large house								f. then (that + TIME)								
	g. as a youth (while a young man)																
3.4	qokä																

Commentary

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Problem Author: Aleka Akoyunoglou (Blackwell). Reference: Whitehead, Carl (2004). *A Reference Grammar of Menya, an Angan language of Papua New Guinea*, Ph.D. Dissertation, U of Manitoba.

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Solution and marking.

Scoring

- 4.1. 1 point for each correct cell (max 7)
- 4.2. 2 points for each correct answer (max 20)
 - 1 point with one wrong letter.

4.1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	a	d	e	h	g	f	c	b
4.2	a. xakŭnú				b. xañíʔní			
	c. Kuʔu Maria.				d. Kwáá Pedro.			
	e. Pedro kúu ɨ xakwáá.				f. Kwaʔá saʔma.			
	g. Saʔmarí kúu xatûû.				h. Kaa ndáa.			
	i. Ndáa.				j. Kúu xandáa.			

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Commentary

This problem is based on several features of Chalcatongo Mixtec – however, for the purposes of the problem, some of the tasks & the discussion below have been simplified.

1. Two copulas:

Chalcatongo Mixtec has two verbs that can be used as copulas: *kúu* and *kaa*.

- *Kúu* is used when the predicate is a noun phrase, as in example sentence 2: *Maria kúu # xasiʔi*. = Maria is a woman.
- However, when the predicate consists of an adjective, the copula is *kaa*. This can be seen in example sentence 4: *Juan kaa lúli*. = Juan is short / small.

2. The copula “kaa” as optional & its role in adding emphasis to the subject as sentence topic:

The copula *kaa* is also optional – as example sentences 1 and 3 demonstrate. Sentence 1 features the copula *kaa*. *Nduča kaa ñiʔní*. – this means that the subject of the sentence, *nduča*, is stressed or emphasised. The speaker is referring to a particular volume of water, whereas in sentence 3, the copula *kaa* can be omitted: *Ñiʔní nduča*. In this case, the speaker is not emphasising a particular volume of water, they are not putting any emphasis on the water as topic & subject of this sentence.

Interestingly, the word order (which is mostly VSO in Chalcatongo Mixtec, but not consistently) changes when the copula *kaa* is omitted, the predicate (adjective) precedes the subject.

3. Nominalization: making nouns out of adjectives

By adding the prefix *xa-* to an existing adjective, you can create a noun with a similar meaning as the original adjective. In example sentence 6: the adjective *siʔi* translates as “feminine”, while in example sentence 2: *Maria kúu # xasiʔi*, a new noun has been formed by adding *xa* to *siʔi*, creating the noun “woman”.

4. Possessive marker –rí:

The suffix *-rí* can be added to the end of a noun to express first person singular possessive (i.e. “my” or “mine”). Example sentence 8 demonstrates this: *Pedro kúu xalúlírí*. Here the original adjective *lúli* (small, short) has become a noun through having the nominalizer *xa-* prefixed (making it mean “child”) and the adding of the suffix *-rí* can be translated as the possessive determiner “my”.

References:

- Macaulay, M. (2002). The syntax of Chalcatongo Mixtec Preverbal and postverbal. In Carnie, A, Harley, H & Dooley, S. A. (Eds), *Verb First. On the syntax of verb initial languages* (pp.). Philadelphia: John Benjamins Publishing Company.
- Macaulay, M. (1993). Argument Status and Constituent Structure in Chalcatongo Mixtec. *Proceedings of the annual meeting of the Berkeley Linguistics Society*, 19(2), 73-85.

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<https://www.ethnologue.com/language/mig>

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Solution and marking.

Scoring (max 31)

- 13-15: 3 points for each correct sentence. (max 9)
 - 1 less for each wrong word, till zero.
- 16-18: 1 point for each correct word. (max 22)
 - No half marks.

13	I hear a moon below you.
14	You shake the clam next to your owl.
15	We do not see your banana in front of my sons.
16	yangna dakinawan balna mukusni balna kurarahwaski yangna taakitna yak.
17	wasni yaihnit yak sunilu palani yamtaman.
18	pinsil balna buitayang manna titinghmana minit yak.

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Commentary

Syntax

(PP) S O (PP) V (PP) word order

PP (marked by locative marker *yak*) can appear in all positions except between S and O.

Nouns

Definite + possessive markers for nouns are infixes with the nouns. There is no phonological rule for the location of the infixing, but instead each word has a specific location where all infixes go. For example, the word *su-lu* (dog) has all infixes placed in between the two syllables (e.g. *sunilu* = the dog, *sukilu* = my dog, etc).

Plural is expressed with the word *balna* which follows the word.

	1st person	2nd person	3rd person
Singular	-ki-	-ma-	-ni- (also the definite article)
Plural	-kina-	-mana-	-nina-

In the case of the location words, the plural affix -na- is suffixed (e.g. mi-**ki-t-na**).

Possession: Possessor + Possessee (marked as above)

Two location words also undergo vowel harmonising in the 2nd person (mi-ma-t > mamat, di-ma-t > damat).

Verbs

positive negative	1st	2nd	3rd
Singular	-(ta)yang -(ta)syang	-(ta)man -(ta)sman	-wi -waski
Plural	-(ta)yangna -(ta)syangna	-(ta)manna -(ta)smanna	as 3s but with stem reduplication

In the 3rd person plural, the final syllable of the stem is reduplicated:

tal > tatal
yam > yayam
(bui > bubui)
kurah > kurarah

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kas > kakas

dakaa > dakakaa

The syllable coda/vowel length is deleted in the reduplication. The -ta- suffix is not present in the verbs *hear* or *see* (the fact they are both verbs of perception is actually a coincidence).